FRAMEWORK
FOUNDRY
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WEEK ENDING
Feb 28, 2026
International Edition

COVERAGE: EUROPE · ASIA-PACIFIC · EMERGING MARKETS · FX · MACRO
EU JP

The Week in Brief

International markets posted mostly gains this week, with Nikkei 225 (Asia-Pacific) leading at +3.28% and Hang Seng (Asia-Pacific) lagging at -0.63%. European indices outperformed on average (+1.04%); Asia-Pacific led (+1.31% average); Emerging Markets (MSCI EM) moved +0.90%. On the FX front, the Japanese Yen weakened 0.97%, all against the USD.

The macro picture was eventful. Germany Ifo Business Climate (February) came in above expectations (88.6 vs. 88.4).

Looking ahead, key events to watch are: Eurozone CPI Flash (February, YoY), Australia Q4 2025 GDP (QoQ). Central bank decisions in particular can drive sharp FX and equity moves; position sizing should reflect that risk.

Index Snapshot

EU EUROPE

Euro Stoxx 50	+0.40%
CAC 40	+0.99%
DAX	+0.68%
FTSE 100	+2.09%

ASIA-PACIFIC

Nikkei 225	+3.28%
Hang Seng	-0.63%
ASX 200	+1.29%

EMERGING MARKETS

MSCI EM	+0.90%

Market Snapshot

INDEX	REGION	CLOSE	WEEKLY %	WEEK RANGE
Nikkei 225	Asia-Pacific	58,850.27	+3.28%	56,680.88 – 59,332.43
FTSE 100	Europe	10,910.60	+2.09%	10,645.80 – 10,934.90
ASX 200	Asia-Pacific	9,198.60	+1.29%	8,987.20 – 9,202.90
CAC 40	Europe	8,580.75	+0.99%	8,461.88 – 8,642.23
MSCI EM	Emerging Markets	62.58	+0.90%	61.51 – 65.96
DAX	Europe	25,284.26	+0.68%	24,878.10 – 25,405.97

INDEX	REGION	CLOSE	WEEKLY %	WEEK RANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	Europe	6,138.41	+0.40%	6,084.69 – 6,199.78
Hang Seng	Asia-Pacific	26,630.54	-0.63%	26,373.01 – 27,156.28

▲ Best: Nikkei 225 (+3.28%)

▼ Worst: Hang Seng (-0.63%)

FX RATES

CURRENCY PAIR	RATE	WEEKLY %
AUD/USD	0.7102	-0.08%
CHF/USD	1.2933	-0.17%
EUR/USD	1.1803	-0.23%
GBP/USD	1.3491	-0.28%
JPY/USD	0.0064	-0.97%

▲ Best: AUD/USD (-0.08%)

▼ Worst: JPY/USD (-0.97%)

Last Week's Economic Events

DATE	EVENT	ACTUAL	EXPECTED	PREVIOUS	SURPRISE
2026-02-23	Germany Ifo Business Climate (February)	88.6	88.4	87.6	Above
2026-02-24	BOJ Summary of Opinions (January MPM)	--	--	--	Inline
2026-02-25	Eurozone CPI Final (January, YoY)	1.7%	1.7%	2.0%	Inline

📈 GERMANY IFO BUSINESS CLIMATE (FEBRUARY)

German business confidence rose for the second consecutive month, reaching its highest level since August 2025. Manufacturing expectations improved on stronger order flows and upward production planning revisions. However, at 88.6 the index remains well below the long-run average, signaling a recovery that is tentative at best. Euro edged higher on the data; a sustained move above 90 would be needed to confirm a genuine turnaround in Europe's largest economy.

🏦 BOJ SUMMARY OF OPINIONS (JANUARY MPM)

The summary of opinions from the BOJ's January 22-23 meeting (at which the policy rate was held at 0.75%) revealed an increasingly hawkish internal debate. Multiple members indicated readiness to raise rates further if spring Shunto wage negotiations confirm broad-based pay increases above 3%. The yen firmed modestly on publication. EWJ outlook remains mixed: a stronger yen pressures exporters, but a normalizing BOJ signals macro confidence. Next BOJ meeting in late March is now a live event for markets.

🔥 EUROZONE CPI FINAL (JANUARY, YOY)

Final Eurozone CPI for January confirmed the flash estimate at 1.7% â€" the lowest since September 2024 and well below the ECB's 2% target. Core CPI was confirmed at 2.2%, its lowest since October 2021. The print reinforces the ECB's data-dependent hold stance adopted at its February 5 meeting. Modestly positive for Eurozone rate-

sensitive assets (EZU, FXE); the low inflation backdrop gives the ECB room to cut later in 2026 if growth disappoints.

Upcoming Week

DATE	EVENT	IMPORTANCE
2026-03-02	China NBS Manufacturing PMI (February)	Medium
2026-03-03	Eurozone CPI Flash (February, YoY)	High
2026-03-04	Australia Q4 2025 GDP (QoQ)	High
2026-03-06	Eurozone Q4 2025 GDP Final (YoY)	Medium

Positioning Tips

SIGNAL	SUGGESTED ACTION
The Japanese Yen weakened 0.97% against the USD	This reduces USD returns on unhedged Japan exposure (EWJ). Watch BOJ policy signals; any rate hike could trigger a sharp Yen reversal.
Eurozone CPI Flash on 2026-03-03	A hot print would extend the ECB hold and pressure European bond proxies, while a soft print opens the door for H2 rate cuts, supportive of EFA, FEZ, and EUR-denominated duration.

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